



AGRICULTURE

VARIABLES: Percentage of cropped area under cash crops, GSDP/rural population, power consumption for agriculture/rural population, foodgrain yield, loans extended for crops, net irrigated area/net sown area.

BIG STATES

RANK 2008		2008*	RANK 2007	2006	2005	2004
1	PUNJAB	6.52	1	1	1	1
2	HARYANA	3.93	4	2	2	2
3	TAMIL NADU	3.73	2	3	3	3
4	ANDHRA PRADESH	2.56	3	5	4	4
5	KARNATAKA	2.33	6	6	6	7
6	GUJARAT	1.90	5	4	5	5
7	UTTAR PRADESH	1.43	8	8	7	6
8	WEST BENGAL	1.32	9	7	8	8
9	MAHARASHTRA	1.26	7	10	11	13
10	RAJASTHAN	1.21	12	9	9	10
11	UTTARAKHAND	1.14	10	12	14	14
12	MADHYA PRADESH	1.13	11	11	13	9
13	KERALA	1.05	13	13	10	12
14	HIMACHAL PRADESH	0.85	15	16	16	16
15	BIHAR	0.82	14	14	12	11
16	JAMMU & KASHMIR	0.70	16	15	15	15
17	ORISSA	0.66	17	17	17	17
18	CHHATTISGARH	0.44	18	18	20	19
19	ASSAM	0.24	20	20	19	18
20	JHARKHAND	0.11	19	19	18	20

SMALL STATES

1	PUDUCHERRY	8.09	1	1	1	1
2	GOA	2.12	3	3	3	3
3	DELHI	2.04	2	2	2	2
4	MANIPUR	0.65	5	7	6	4
5	TRIPURA	0.60	7	4	4	5
6	MEGHALAYA	0.49	4	5	5	7
7	MIZORAM	0.46	8	6	8	6
8	SIKKIM	0.42	9	10	9	9
9	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	0.42	6	8	7	10
10	NAGALAND	0.30	10	9	10	8

UNION TERRITORIES

1	LAKSHADWEEP	3.68	2	3	4	4
2	CHANDIGARH	1.74	3	2	2	2
3	ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS	1.46	1	1	1	1
4	DAMAN & DIU	0.45	4	5	3	3
5	DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI	0.39	5	4	5	5

Rank went down Constant rank Rank went up Fastest Mover

populace on agriculture. But barring the war-horse Punjab and Puducherry among the smaller states, not a single state scores more than 4. Bihar, not surprisingly, is locked at number 20 among the big states, scoring less than one out of 10 in seven of the parameters.

The theory is that growth in emerging economies is driven by education, health care, investment in agriculture, good governance and investment in infrastructure. And, it is on these parameters that states are doing the worst. Take governance, which is purely about upholding the rule of law and ensuring peace. The scores show that 18 of the 20 big states and eight of the 10 small states do abysmally. On health care, 16 of the big states and five of the small states do just as badly. In many ways the disaggregated picture of the rankings reflect the apathy that rules states. Poor legacy could have been an excuse for states like Bihar and Uttar Pradesh some years back, but not anymore. Clearly, there has been little attempt to address the basics. How can Bihar defend the stark reality that only three out of 10 births in the state are assisted by medical personnel.

Political parties seem to believe that sops are the answer to lifting the huddled masses out of the well of depression. Obviously, a lot of this is due to these parties participating in a competitive race downhill. Mercifully, the study shows this doesn't help beyond the electronic voting machines. Real growth stems from real



MADHYA PRADESH IS THE FASTEST MOVER

Bipartisan support for investment in restructuring agriculture and involvement of private mandis see the state poised as an alternate granary. Coming up next, contract farming.

GROWTH MANTRA: Investments deliver jobs.

